METHODOLOGY
MSCI SUSTAINABILITY AND CLIMATE

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MSCI ESG Ratings Methodology: Toxic Emissions & Waste Key Issue

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Introduction

This document provides essential information on the components of the Toxic Emissions & Waste Key Issue to enable users of ESG Ratings to understand how MSCI Sustainability & Climate's (MSCI S&C's)[1] outputs are determined. Toxic Emissions & Waste is a Key Issue in the Environmental Pillar of the MSCI ESG Ratings model. Companies are evaluated on the potential environmental contamination and toxic or carcinogenic emissions arising from their operations and the strength of their environmental management systems.

For additional details on the MSCI ESG Ratings Model, refer to the Data, ratings and scores section of "ESG Ratings Methodology."

Exhibit 1: MSCI ESG Key Issue hierarchy

3 Pillars	10 Themes	33 ESG Key Issues
Environmental	Climate Change	Carbon Emissions
		Climate Change Vulnerability
		Financing Environmental Impact
		Product Carbon Footprint
	Natural Capital	Biodiversity & Land Use
		Raw Material Sourcing
		Water Stress
	Pollution & Waste	Electronic Waste
		Packaging Material & Waste
		Toxic Emissions & Waste
	Environmental Opportunities	Opportunities in Clean Tech
		Opportunities in Green Building
		Opportunities in Renewable Energy
Social	Human Capital	Health & Safety
		Human Capital Development
		Labor Management
		Supply Chain Labor Standards
	Product Liability	Chemical Safety
		Consumer Financial Protection
		Privacy & Data Security
		Product Safety & Quality
		Responsible Investment
	Stakeholder Opposition	Community Relations
		Controversial Sourcing
	Social Opportunities	Access to Finance
		Access to Health Care
		Opportunities in Nutrition & Health

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3 Pillars	10 Themes	33 ESG Key Issues
Governance	Corporate Governance	Board
		Pay
		Ownership & Control
		Accounting
	Corporate Behavior	Business Ethics
		Tax Transparency

Risks associated with this Key Issue

- Increased costs from liabilities associated with damaging health, property.
- Loss of access to markets through community opposition, heightened regulatory hurdles.
- Increased costs to meet compliance standards and install equipment and systems to contain pollution.

Toxic Emissions & Waste Key Issue score

The Toxic Emissions & Waste Key Issue score evaluates the company's level of exposure to, and management of, risks on this Key Issue. The Key Issue score is based on the Exposure score and the Management score using the formula below. The Exposure score and the Management score are combined such that a higher level of exposure requires a higher level of demonstrated management capability in order to achieve the same overall Key Issue score.

$$KI_i = 7 - (\max(EXP_i, 2) - MGMT_i)$$

Where:

- KI_i is the Key Issue score for company i.
- EXP_i is the Exposure score for company i.
- $MGMT_i$ is the Management score for company i.

Toxic Emissions & Waste Management framework

The table below outlines the indicators mapped to their respective components that inform the Toxic Emissions & Waste Management score, excluding controversies. MSCI S&C assigns each indicator a default weight. Indicator weights may be adjusted at the company level to reflect the relevance of the indicator to the company's business activities. If a company has no exposure to the business activities covered by an indicator, the indicator is assigned a weight of zero.

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Component	Sustainability Indicator
Toxic Emissions & Waste Governance and Strategy score	Scope and frequency of environmental impact audits
	Existence of environmental management system
	Extent of programs to reduce toxic emissions of supply chain
	Scope of policies to address environmental impacts
	Certified environmental system score
Toxic Emissions & Waste Targets score	Toxic emissions & waste target comprehensiveness
	Toxic emissions & waste target progress
Toxic Emissions & Waste Performance score	NOx emissions performance relative to peers
	SOx emissions performance relative to peers
	VOC emissions performance relative to peers
	Particulate matter emissions performance relative to peers
	Hazardous waste performance relative to peers
	Non-hazardous waste performance relative to peers

Toxic Emissions & Waste Management score

The Toxic Emissions & Waste Management score evaluates the company's ability to manage its exposure to risks on this Key Issue. It is based on weighted average of the score associated with each relevant indicator, modified by controversies.

This score is derived from indicators that are scored on a 0-10 scale, with 10 corresponding to best practice. Refer to the Analyzing risk management section of "ESG Ratings Methodology" for additional details. Sources are company disclosures except where otherwise indicated.

The following formula is used to calculate the Toxic Emissions & Waste Management score - Excluding Controversies:

$$MGMT_i = \sum Indicator_Score_{j,i} \ * \ Indicator_Weight_{j,i}$$

Where:

- $MGMT_i$ is the Management score - Excluding Controversies for company i.

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- $Indicator_Score_{j,i}$ is the score of indicator j for company i.
- $Indicator_Weight_{j,i}$ is the weight of indicator j for company i.

The following formula is used to calculate the scores for the components

$$COMP_{c,i} = \sum_{j \in c} Indicator_Score_{j,i} * Indicator_Weight_Scaled_{j,i}$$

Where:

- $COMP_{c,i}$ is the component score for component c, for company i.
- $Indicator_Score_{j,i}$ is the score of indicator j for company i.
- $Indicator_Weight_Scaled_{j,i}$ is the scaled weight of indicator j for company i.
- $j \in c$ indicates that the summation is over all indicators belonging to component c.

The following formula is used to calculate the weights for the components

$$COMP_Weight_{c,i} = \sum_{j \in c} Indicator_Weight_{j,i}$$

Where:

- $COMP_Weight_{c,i}$ is the component weight for component c for company i.
- $Indicator_Weight_{j,i}$ is the weight of indicator j for company i.
- $j \in c$ indicates that the summation is over all indicators belonging to component c.

The definitions of the data points in each component are given below:

Toxic Emissions & Waste Governance and Strategy score

The Toxic Emissions & Waste Governance and Strategy score evaluates the company's initiatives to govern and manage toxic emissions and waste through policies, environmental management systems, certifications, audits, and supply chain programs. Highest initiatives reflect comprehensive policies, certified systems, and proactive oversight across operations and suppliers. It is expressed as a 0–10 score, where 10 indicates strong initiatives.

- **Scope and frequency of environmental impact audits**

Definition: Assesses whether the company conducts regular audits to assess and manage environmental risks and impacts. Expressed as a 0-10 score, with 10 indicating strong initiatives.

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- **Evidence of environmental impact audits**

Definition: Indicates whether there is evidence that the company conducts internal and/or external environmental audits of its relevant operations. This could include, for example, an EMS certified to ISO 14001 or a similar framework, which requires regular audits.

- **Evidence of audits across all locations of operations**

Definition: Indicates whether there is evidence of environmental audits across all locations of operations.

- **Evidence of annual environmental impact audits**

Definition: Indicates whether there is evidence that the company carries out annual environmental impact audits.

- **Existence of environmental management system**

Definition: Indicates whether there is evidence that the company has an Environmental Management System (EMS) in place across all or selected relevant operations. This could include, for example, an EMS certified to ISO 14001, registration under EMAS, or a similar framework.

- **Extent of programs to reduce toxic emissions of supply chain**

Definition: Indicates the extent to which the company has established programs to reduce toxic emissions within its supply chain. Best practice is for suppliers' environmental management to be subject to screening and audits.

- **Scope of policies to address environmental impacts**

Definition: Indicates whether the company has formal policies in place to address environmental impacts such as air emissions, water discharges, and waste.

- **Certified environmental system score**

Definition: Assesses the extent of the company's sites with an environmental management system certified to ISO 14001 or similar. Expressed as a 0-10 score, with 10 indicating the highest degree of certification.

- **Percentage of operations with an environmental management system certified to ISO 14001 or HAZWOPER**

Definition: The percentage of sites with hazardous waste guidance that follow ISO 14001 or HAZWOPER certification for waste management.

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Toxic Emissions & Waste Targets score

The Toxic Emissions & Waste Targets score evaluates the company's initiatives to set and achieve targets for reducing toxic emissions and waste. Highest initiatives reflect comprehensive, quantitative reduction targets with demonstrated progress toward achievement. It is expressed as a 0–10 score, where 10 indicates strong initiatives.

- **Toxic emissions & waste target comprehensiveness**

Definition: Assesses the extent to which a company has established toxic waste reduction targets that have a measurable reduction scope and are complete in coverage. Expressed as a 0-10 score, with 10 indicating a quantitative target that covers all segments.

  - **Evidence of ongoing Toxic Emissions & Waste target**

    Definition: Indicates whether the company has an ongoing toxic emissions and/or waste reduction target.

  - **Scope of ongoing Toxic Emissions & Waste target**

    Definition: Assess the scope of coverage of the ongoing toxic emissions and/or waste target. Expressed as a 0-10 score, where 10 indicates that the target covers all relevant segments of the company's operations.

- **Toxic emissions & waste target progress**

Definition: Assesses the company's to-date progress on active toxic emissions & waste targets, as well as its historical track record in meeting previously stated targets. Expressed as a 0-10 score, with 10 indicating achievement of stated target.

  - **Status of ongoing Toxic Emissions & Waste target**

    Definition: Measures the current implementation status of the company's ongoing target on toxic emissions and/or waste management, by assessing the current progress against the target.

  - **Status of historical Toxic Emissions & Waste target**

    Definition: Measures the achievement or completion status of the company's historical target on toxic emissions and/or waste management, by assessing whether the stated target was achieved or not.

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Toxic Emissions & Waste Performance score

The Toxic Emissions & Waste Performance score evaluates the company's performance on toxic emissions and waste metrics (including NOx emissions, SOx emissions, particulate matter emissions, hazardous and non-hazardous waste, and other relevant pollutants), relative to its peers. It is expressed as a 0-10 score, where 10 indicates strong performance.

- **NOx emissions performance relative to peers**

Definition: Assesses the company's performance on nitrogen oxides (NOx) emissions intensity (normalized by sales or by units of production), and trend in NOx emissions intensity, relative to its peers. Expressed as a 0-10 score, where 10 indicates strong performance.

  - **NOx emissions intensity industry relative score**

    Definition: Assesses the company's performance on nitrogen oxide (NOx) emissions intensity (emissions per unit of sales or production), relative to its peers. Expressed as a 0-10 score, where 10 indicates strong performance.

    - **Three-year average NOx emissions intensity (sales based)**

      Definition: Measures the company's three-year average NOx emissions (per unit of sales).

    - **Three-year average NOx emissions intensity (production based)**

      Definition: Measures the company's three-year average NOx emissions (per megawatt-hour generated).

  - **NOx emissions intensity industry relative trend score**

    Definition: Assesses the company's performance on the three-year average of year-over-year NOx emissions (per unit of sales or production) trend, relative to its peers. Expressed as a 0-10 score, where 10 indicates strong performance.

    - **Three-year average NOx emissions intensity trend (sales based)**

      Definition: Measures the company's three-year average of year-over-year NOx emissions (per unit of sales) trend.

    - **Three-year average NOx emissions intensity trend (production based)**

      Definition: Measures the company's three-year average of year-over-year NOx emissions (per megawatt-hour generated) trend.

- **SOx emissions performance relative to peers**

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Definition: Assesses the company's performance on sulfur oxides (SOx) emissions intensity (normalized by sales or by units of production), and trend in SOx emissions intensity, relative to its peers. Expressed as a 0-10 score, where 10 indicates strong performance.

- **SOx emissions intensity industry relative score**

  Definition: Assesses the company's performance on sulfur oxide (SOx) emissions intensity emissions (per unit of sales or production), relative to its peers. Expressed as a 0–10 score, where 10 indicates strong performance.

  - **Three-year average SOx emissions intensity (sales based)**

    Definition: Measures the company's three-year average SOx emissions (per unit of sales).

  - **Three-year average SOx emissions intensity (production based)**

    Definition: Measures the company's three-year average SOx emissions (per megawatt-hour generated).

- **SOx emissions intensity industry relative trend score**

  Definition: Assesses the company's performance on the three-year average of year-over-year SOx emissions (per unit of sales or production) trend, relative to its peers. Expressed as a 0–10 score, where 10 indicates strong performance.

  - **Three-year average SOx emissions intensity trend (sales based)**

    Definition: Measures the company's three-year average of year-over-year SOx emissions (per unit of sales) trend.

  - **Three-year average SOx emissions intensity trend (production based)**

    Definition: Measures the company's three-year average of year-over-year SOx emissions (per megawatt-hour generated) trend.

- **VOC emissions performance relative to peers**

Definition: Assesses the company's performance on volatile organic compounds (VOC) emissions intensity (normalized by sales), and trend in VOC emissions intensity, relative to its peers. Expressed as a 0-10 score, where 10 indicates strong performance.

- **VOC emissions intensity industry relative score**

  Definition: Assesses the company's performance on volatile organic compounds (VOC) emissions intensity (emissions per unit of sales), relative to its peers. Expressed as a 0–10 score, where 10 indicates strong performance.

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- **Three-year average VOC emissions intensity (sales based)**

Definition: Measures the company's three-year average VOC emissions per unit of sales.

- **VOC emissions intensity (sales based) industry relative trend score**

Definition: Assesses the company's performance on the three-year average of year-over-year VOC emissions (per unit of sales) trend, relative to its peers. Expressed as a 0–10 score, where 10 indicates strong performance.

- **Three-year average VOC emissions intensity trend (sales based)**

Definition: Measures the company's three-year average of year-over-year VOC emissions (per unit of sales) trend.

- **Particulate matter emissions performance relative to peers**

Definition: Assesses the company's performance on particulate matter (PM) emissions intensity (normalized by sales), and trend in PM emissions intensity), relative to its peers. Expressed as a 0-10 score, where 10 indicates strong performance.

- **Particulate matter emissions intensity industry relative score**

Definition: Assesses the company's performance on particulate matter (PM) emissions intensity (emissions per unit of sales) relative to its peers. Expressed as a 0–10 score, where 10 indicates strong performance.

- **Three-year average particulate matter emissions intensity (sales based)**

Definition: Measures the company's three-year average particulate matter emissions (per unit of sales).

- **Particulate matter emissions intensity industry relative trend score**

Definition: Assesses the company's performance on the three-year average of year-over-year particulate matter emissions intensity (per unit of sales) trend, relative to its industry peers. Expressed as a 0–10 score, where 10 indicates strong performance.

- **Three-year average particulate matter emissions intensity trend (sales based)**

Definition: Measures the company's three-year average of year-over-year particulate matter emissions intensity(per unit of sales) trend.

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- **Hazardous waste performance relative to peers**

Definition: Assesses the company's performance on hazardous waste intensity (normalized by sales), and trend in hazardous waste intensity, relative to its peers. Expressed as a 0-10 score, where 10 indicates strong performance.

- **Hazardous waste intensity industry relative score**

Definition: Assesses the company's performance on hazardous waste generated normalized by sales, relative to its industry peers. Expressed as a 0-10 score, where 10 indicates strong performance.

- **Three-year average hazardous waste intensity (sales based)**

Definition: Measures the company's three-year average hazardous waste generated per unit of sales.

- **Hazardous waste intensity industry relative trend score**

Definition: Assesses the company's performance on the three-year average of year-over-year hazardous waste generated (per unit of sales) trend, relative to its industry peers. Expressed as a 0-10 score, where 10 indicates strong performance.

- **Three-year average hazardous waste intensity trend (sales based)**

Definition: Measures the company's three-year average of year-over-year hazardous waste generated (per unit of sales) trend.

- **Non-hazardous waste performance relative to peers**

Definition: Assesses the company's performance on non-hazardous waste intensity (normalized by sales), and trend in non-hazardous waste intensity, relative to its peers. Expressed as a 0-10 score, where 10 indicates strong performance.

- **Non-hazardous waste intensity industry relative score**

Definition: Assesses the company's performance on non-hazardous waste generated (normalized by sales), relative to its industry peers. Expressed as a 0–10 score, where 10 indicates strong performance.

- **Three-year average non-hazardous waste intensity (sales based)**

Definition: Measures the company's three-year average non-hazardous waste generated (per unit of sales).

- **Non-hazardous waste intensity industry relative trend score**

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Definition: Assesses the company's performance on the three-year average of year-over-year non-hazardous generated (per unit of sales) trend, relative to its industry peers. Expressed as a 0–10 score, where 10 indicates strong performance.

- **Three-year average non-hazardous waste intensity trend (sales based)**

  Definition: Measures the company's three-year average of year-over-year non-hazardous waste generated (per unit of sales) trend.

Source: Environmental Protection Agency's (EPA's) Resource Conservation and Recovery Act Biennial Reporting.

Controversies

A controversy deduction ranging from 0 to 5 points is subtracted from the overall Management score based on the severity, status, and the company's role in the controversies facing the company on this Key Issue. The following categories of controversies are used in the assessment:

- Toxic emissions and spills controversies.

For more details on how controversies are included in the MSCI ESG Ratings model, refer to the Controversies cases section of "ESG Ratings Methodology."

Toxic Emissions & Waste Exposure score

The Toxic Emissions & Waste Exposure score evaluates the company's exposure to risks on this Key Issue. It is based on the Business Exposure score only. The Business Exposure score is scored on a 0-10 scale, with 10 corresponding to the highest risk and 0 corresponding to the lowest risk. Refer to the Analyzing risk exposure section of "ESG Ratings Methodology" for additional details. The following formula is used in the Exposure score calculation:

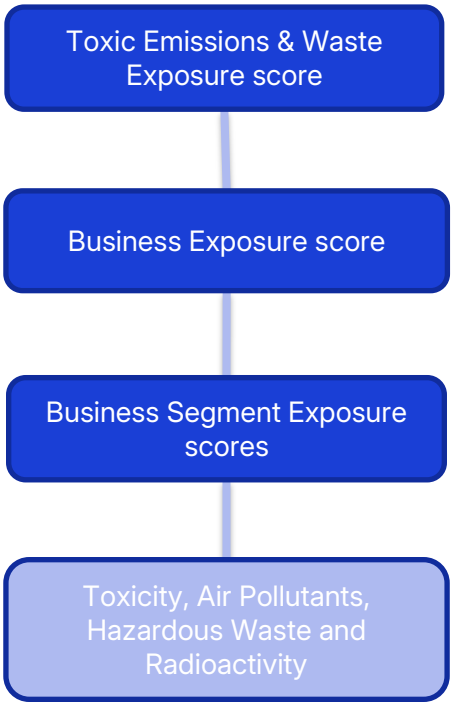
$$EXP_{TEW,i} = BUS_{TEW,i}$$

Where:

- $EXP_{TEW,i}$ is the Toxic Emissions & Waste Exposure score of company i.
- $BUS_{TEW,i}$ is the Toxic Emissions & Waste Business Exposure score of company i.

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Exhibit 2: Exposure score components



Business Exposure score

The Business Exposure score is a weighted average of the Toxic Emissions & Waste Business Segment Exposure scores of a company's business segments. scores are weighted by the proportion of a company's total assets in each business segment,[2] using the following formula to calculate the Business Exposure score:

$$BUS_{TEW,i} = \sum_{j=1}^{n_i} w_{Asset,i,j} BSE_{TEW,j}$$

Where:

- $BSE_{TEW,j}$ is the Toxic Emissions & Waste Business Segment Exposure score for business segment j.
- $w_{Asset,i,j}$ is the weight of business segment j for company i based on the contribution to total company assets.

[2] The percentage of assets is typically calculated as the company-reported asset value of the segment divided by the total asset value. In certain cases, industry-specific metrics are used to calculate the percentage of assets, such as power generation, production volume or reserve value. In cases where neither segment assets nor a relevant industry-specific proxy is available, the percentage is calculated based on segment revenue.

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- n_i is the number of business segments of company i.

Business Segment Exposure scores

The Toxic Emissions & Waste Business Segment Exposure score of a business segment is based on a mapping of the business segment as disclosed by the company to a corresponding business activity. MSCI S&C uses the Standard Industrial Classification (SIC) system along with industry-specific adjustments to define business activities. The score associated with a business activity is used to calculate a Business Segment Exposure score. Each business activity score is determined by a simple average of the Toxicity score, Air Pollutant score, Hazardous Waste score and Radioactivity score of the business activity:

$$BSE_{TEW,j} = \frac{TS_j + APS_j + HWS_j + RS_j}{4}$$

Where:

- TS_j is the Toxicity score for business activity j.
- APS_j is the Air Pollutant score for business activity j.
- HWS_j is the Hazardous Waste score for business activity j.
- RS_j is the Radioactivity score for business activity j.

The Toxicity score of a business activity is assessed by examining the toxicity and carcinogenicity (oral and inhalation) risk associated with toxic emissions.

The Air Pollutant score of a business activity is assessed by taking a simple average of emissions of carbon monoxide (CO), volatile organic compounds (VOCs), nitrogen oxides (NOx), sulphur oxides (SOx) and particulate matter of 10 micrometer diameter (PM10).

The Hazardous Waste score of a business activity is assessed by examining tons of hazardous waste produced per facility.

The Radioactivity score of a business activity is assessed through a qualitative assessment of the mining industry. Mining activities related to highly radioactive ores receive a score of 10.

Data sources

The following sources are used to determine the Toxic Emissions & Waste Exposure score:

The EPA's Toxics Release Inventory, National Emissions Inventory, and Risk-Screening Environmental Indicators; U.S. Economic Census; Refinitiv; MSCI S&C; company disclosures.

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